

procedure to be developed so that the adverse effects arising out of such outages can be somewhat mitigated, at least initially. Experts also argue that to mitigate such outages in the near future, a robust IT infrastructure, such as load balancing and failover systems, is crucial. And keeping systems and software up to date remains a best practice still, despite the CrowdStrike situation.

According to Jain, the government's role in regulating the IT industry is also important, because it prevents monopolies from being created. He suggests that India should invest in developing its own mobile and com-

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THIS INCIDENT SHOWS THE FRAGILITY OF OUR TECH-DRIVEN WORLD

puter operating systems to reduce dependence on foreign technology.

But such solutions, at least at this stage, are still works in progress and this incident would only propel experts to swiftly come up with a set of solutions. Nevertheless, the CrowdStrike incident serves as a stark reminder of the vulnerabilities present in our digital infrastructure. It shows us that as businesses become more dependent upon technology, outages will become common. Thus arises the urgent need for evolving comprehensive strategies to mitigate such risks and ensure resilience. **BT**

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AUTO

Charging Ahead

The Ola Electric IPO, the first public listing by a domestic EV firm, will have a positive impact on all entities of its parent ANI Technologies, stimulating their growth

BY ASTHA ORIEL & RAHUL OBEROI

► **"PEOPLE REMEMBER HOW** Maruti [Suzuki India] grew after its IPO (initial public offering), so we wanted to bring that for the public investors, to be part of our journey if they wish to," Bhavish Aggarwal, Founder of Ola Electric Mobility, said in a recent podcast, drawing a comparison to Maruti's IPO 20 years ago. Market analysts, however, think that Ola Electric Mobility, which is hitting the capital markets soon, must reach profitability first.

This will be the first public listing by a domestic electric vehicles (EV) company. The public offer, which will open from August 2-6, is a combination of a fresh issue of ₹5,500 crore and an offer for sale of up to 84.94 million equity shares by the promoters and investors. The company will raise up to ₹6,146 crore at the upper price band of ₹76 per share.

"Ola is already a proven brand," says Puneet Gupta, Director at ratings agency S&P Global. "Now it needs capital to expand operations" due to the massive size of

the Indian two-wheeler market, which is currently approaching 10-15 million units annually. Once Ola Electric becomes a listed company, says Gupta, a sense of trust will be instilled in its partners and suppliers to give them better pricing.

Ola Electric is coming up with higher valuations, says Kranthi Bathini, Equity Strategist at WealthMills Securities. "Therefore, it must become profitable going forward. Everything will depend on how the future earnings and margins will grow," he says. The company posted a consolidated net loss of ₹1,584 crore

in FY24 compared to a net loss of ₹1,472 crore in the previous year.

According to Ola Electric, ₹1,228 crore of the net proceeds will go towards capital expenditure, ₹1,600 crore for research and development, ₹800 crore for paying off debt, and ₹350 crore for organic growth initiatives.

The Ola Electric IPO is the first pure-play EV IPO of this scale, says independent market analyst

38.7
per cent

**MARKET SHARE OF OLA
ELECTRIC IN INDIA'S EV
MARKET IN H1 2024**